

WhatsApp Setup Details Guide

How to collect Meta phone number ID, WABA ID, and permanent access token for PSHR Saloon & Spa

Prepared for: PSHR Saloon & Spa | Updated June 12, 2026

Important note

Do not print secrets: This guide explains how to collect the values. Do not write the real permanent access token into this PDF, email, screenshots, commits, or chat messages. Paste the token only into the secure WhatsApp setup form or a server-side secret store.

Quick Field Map

App field	What to enter	Where to get it	Common mistake
WhatsApp display number	+918074544223	Use the business phone number connected to your WhatsApp Business Platform account. Include country code.	Do not enter the Meta phone number ID here. This field is the human-visible phone number.
Meta phone number ID	<numeric phone_number_id>	Meta App Dashboard > WhatsApp > API Setup. Select the From phone number, then copy the phone number ID. Also appears in webhook metadata as phone_number_id.	Do not use the visible phone number. The ID is usually a long numeric value.
WABA ID	<numeric WhatsApp Business Account ID>	Meta App Dashboard > WhatsApp > API Setup after connecting the app to a WhatsApp Business Account. Also: Business Settings > Accounts > WhatsApp Business Accounts > select the account.	Do not use Business Portfolio ID or App ID. WABA ID is the WhatsApp Business Account ID.
Permanent access token	<system user access token>	Business Settings > Users > System users > create/choose system user > Assign assets > Generate token for the app.	Do not use the temporary API Setup token. It expires quickly and breaks production messaging.

Before You Start

Requirement	Check
Meta access	You need admin access to the Meta Business Portfolio, the Meta developer app, and the WhatsApp Business Account.
Business phone number	The number should be owned by you, include country/area code, and be able to receive SMS or voice verification. Mobile numbers are the least troublesome.
Cloud API registration	Adding and verifying a number is not always the same as registering it for Cloud API. If API calls fail, confirm the phone number is registered for Cloud API use.
Security	Use a system user token for production. Keep it server-side and rotate it immediately if exposed.

Step-by-Step Collection Process

1. **Open the Meta app:** Go to developers.facebook.com/apps, open the app used for this project, then open WhatsApp or the Connect on WhatsApp use case.
2. **Go to API Setup:** Open Quickstart or API Setup. If prompted, click Start using the API.
3. **Connect or create the WABA:** Select an existing WhatsApp Business Account or create one. Copy the WhatsApp Business Account ID shown in the API Setup panel.
4. **Select the From number:** Choose the business phone number. For this setup, the visible display number is +918074544223. Copy the Meta phone number ID shown for that number.
5. **Create a system user token:** Open business.facebook.com/latest/settings, then Users > System users. Add a system user if needed.
6. **Assign assets:** Assign the Meta app with Manage app/full control. Assign the WhatsApp account with Manage WhatsApp Business Accounts/full control.
7. **Generate the token:** Click Generate token, select the app, choose the no-expiry or longest allowed expiration option, and include `business_management`, `whatsapp_business_management`, and `whatsapp_business_messaging`.
8. **Save in your app:** Paste the display number, Meta phone number ID, WABA ID, and system user token into the WhatsApp setup form. Save, then send a test template message.

After Saving: Test Checklist

Test	Expected result
Send a template test message	Message is accepted by Graph API and delivered to the WhatsApp recipient.
Reply from WhatsApp	Webhook receives a messages event. The payload metadata should show the same phone_number_id.
Check phone number status	In WhatsApp Manager > Account tools > Phone numbers, the number status should be connected.
Store credentials	The token is stored only in your app/backend secret storage. It is not printed in this guide.

Troubleshooting

Symptom	Likely cause	Fix
Token works for a few hours, then fails	Temporary user token from API Setup was used.	Create a system user token and update the Permanent access token field.
OAuth error or permission error 200	The system user does not have access to the WABA or phone number.	Reopen Business Settings, assign the app and WhatsApp Business Account to the system user, then regenerate or retry the token.
Messages fail with the phone number visible in the API URL	The display number was used instead of phone_number_id.	Use the numeric Meta phone number ID in Graph API calls and in the Meta phone number ID field.
WABA ID field is unclear	Looking at Business Portfolio ID or App ID instead of WABA.	Use API Setup or Business Settings > Accounts > WhatsApp Business Accounts, then select the WhatsApp account and copy its ID.
Free-form message is rejected	Outside the 24-hour customer service window.	Use an approved message template unless the customer has messaged you within the last 24 hours.
Production number added but API still fails	The number may be verified but not registered for Cloud API.	Complete Cloud API registration for the number and confirm status is connected.

Source Notes

Meta WhatsApp Business Platform Get Started: <https://developers.facebook.com/documentation/business-messaging/whatsapp/get-started>

Meta WhatsApp Access Tokens Guide:

<https://developers.facebook.com/documentation/business-messaging/whatsapp/access-tokens/>

Meta Manage System Users: <https://developers.facebook.com/documentation/business-messaging/whatsapp/solution-providers/manage-system-users/>

Meta Business Phone Numbers: <https://developers.facebook.com/documentation/business-messaging/whatsapp/business-phone-numbers/phone-numbers>